modern conditions. The land will not and cannot absorb all our people, and large-scale operations will (as Gandhiji fears) lessen the workers required on the land. The others must turn, partly it may be, to small-scale industry, but in the main to large-scale socialised industries and social services.

Khadi has certainly brought some relief in many areas, but this very success that it has attained has an element of danger. It means that it is propping up a decaying land system and delaying, to that extent, the change-over to a better system. The effect is not substantial enough to make a marked difference, but the tendency is there. For the tenant or the small peasant proprietor, his share of the produce of the land is no longer enough to keep him going even on the very low level he has reached. He has to find extraneous aids to his meagre income or, as he does usually, get more into debt, in order to pay his rent or revenue. The additional income thus helps the landlord or the State to realise their share which otherwise they might be unable to do. In the event of the additional income being substantial enough it is likely eventually the rent will rise and catch up to it. Under the present system most of the additional labour of the tenant and his attempts to be thrifty will ultimately benefit the landlord. As far as I can remember, Henry George in his *Progress and Poverty* has dealt with this point, giving instances, especially of Ireland.

Gandhiji's attempt to revive village industries is an extension of his khadi programme. It will do immediate good, part of it more or less permanent, most of it temporary. It will help the villager in his present distress and revive certain artistic and cultural values which were in danger of dying. But in so far as it is a revolt against machinery and industrialism it will not succeed. In a recent article on Village Industries in the *Harijan* Gandhiji writes: "Mechanisation is good when hands are too few for the work intended to be accomplished. It is an evil when there are more hands than required for the work, as is the case of India. . . . The problem with us is not how to find leisure for the teeming millions inhabiting our villages. The problem is how to utilise their idle hours, which are equal to the working days of six months in the year." This objection applies in varying measure to all the countries suffering from unemployment. But the fault surely is not that there is not work to do, but that under the present profit system the work is not profitable enough to the employers. There is an abundance of work simply calling out to be done—the building of